Conversation topics

Lead-in

1. **Work with a partner. Make a list of topics that are OK to discuss when you meet someone for the first time.**

2. **Compare your list with another pair. Are there any topics you would avoid discussing the first time you meet someone? Compare your ideas in groups.**

Listening

1. **Listen to the conversation and select the correct answer.**

   - What is the main topic of this listening?

     a. communicating across cultures
     b. communicating in English
     c. communicating with friends

2. **Have you ever been in the same situation as Zhang or Dewi? What is your advice for people in these situations?**

3. **Read the statements and decide if they are true (T) or false (F). If they are false, correct them.**

   1. Zhang feels comfortable talking to British people because they ask him a lot of questions.
   2. Zhang needs to learn how to participate more in a conversation and not just answer questions.
   3. In the first role play, Zhang listens to what Julie says and asks about her responses.
   4. To have a good conversation you should only give basic answers to questions so the other person has to keep asking more questions.
   5. Asking someone how much money they earn is usually an OK question.
   6. Talking about your surroundings is one of the easiest things to talk about.
   7. In the second role play, Dewi only talks about music at the party.
   8. Alan changed the topic in the role play to a more serious one.
   9. Topics that are seen as too personal are the same across all cultures.
   10. Noi feels that students need to learn how to talk about things in a personal way.

4. **Listen again and check your answers.**

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Vocabulary

1. Try to guess the meaning of the words/phrases from the listening. Choose the best answer.

1. common ground
   a. shared location
   b. shared interests and experiences
   c. shared hometowns and facilities

2. strategy
   a. a careful plan or way of doing something
   b. a way of asking questions
   c. a careful way of controlling a situation

3. interactive
   a. responding to the actions of a user
   b. involving participation from all
   c. requiring people to work together

4. offended
   a. embarrassed by something or someone
   b. confused by something or someone
   c. upset by something or someone

5. taboo topics
   a. things that are not interesting to talk about
   b. things that are not acceptable to talk about
   c. things that must never be talked about

2. Compare your answers with a partner.

3. Choose two or three of the words/phrases to tell a partner your opinion(s) about conversational topics.

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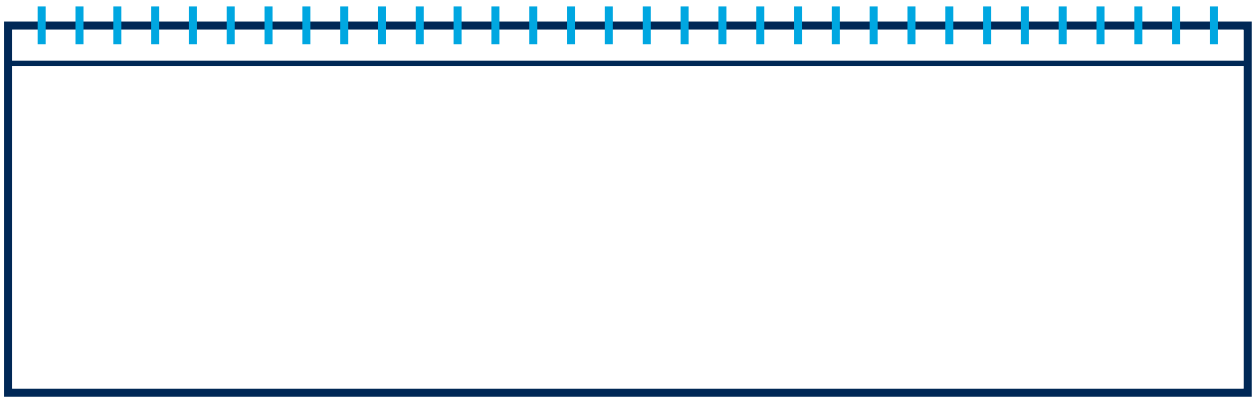
Task

Option 1
You are going to discuss and agree on advice for visitors to your country in relation to acceptable conversation topics. Listen to your teacher's instructions.

Option 2
You are going to role play conversations based on different scenarios. Listen to your teacher's instructions.

Reflection



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